SAMPLE DOCUMENT FOR NOTES EMBEDDER

Why a Highlight Needs a Reason

A short sample paper. Try the highlights and notes that are already on it.

Abstract

Most readers highlight a sentence because it seems important at the time. Weeks later the color is still there, but the reason is gone. A highlight without a reason is only a colored line, and a page full of them is hard to read again. This sample shows a different habit: every highlight carries its own short note, pinned right where the idea is.

1. Why the reason gets lost

Details fade quickly when nothing marks why they mattered. The idea of keeping a reader's own thinking next to the source is an old one. In 1945 Vannevar Bush imagined a desk called the memex, where a reader could build trails between documents and add comments of their own. Highlighting tools today often keep the highlight but not the reason.

The problem grows with volume. A long paper with fifty highlights becomes a wall of color. Sorting them into a few categories, such as ideas, links, definitions, and people, makes it possible to see only what matters for the question at hand.

2. Notes in the margin

Readers have always written in the margins. The word for this is marginalia: notes written beside a text. On paper the margin is small, so notes get tiny, or they never get written. On a screen there is no such limit, so a note can be as long as it needs to be.

Zoom out far enough and the page becomes a small column in the middle. Every note stays open on either side, joined to its highlight by a thin line. This helps before an exam or a meeting, when you want to remember what you thought and not read the whole paper again.

3. Try it yourself

Select any sentence on this page and it is highlighted at once. Press Add note to write why. To copy a sentence without keeping a highlight, press Copy on the small bar or Ctrl+C (Cmd+C on a Mac). Hold Alt (Option on a Mac) while selecting to skip the highlight. Pick a color to sort a highlight into a category. Zoom out with Out, or hold Ctrl (Cmd on a Mac) and scroll, and every note opens beside the page. When you are done, go back to My library and add your own paper.